TANZANIA DRAUGHTS-64

OFFICIAL RULES

Version 3.0 — Comprehensive Edition
Including Online Governance, Engine Compliance & Technical Standards

Tanzania Draughts Federation (TZD Federation)
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Supersedes v2.2. All previous editions are void for competitive play.

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PREAMBLE

These Official Rules govern all forms of Draughts-64 (Drafti / Russian Checkers) played under Tanzania Draughts Federation authority. Throughout this document, 'Tanzania Draughts-64' is referred to as 'TZD' and the 'Tanzania Draughts Federation' is referred to as 'TZD Federation' or 'the Federation.'

TZD rules govern: (1) Over-the-board (OTB) physical play; (2) Online digital play on TZD Federation-approved platforms; (3) Engine-assisted analysis and training; (4) Tournament competition at all levels.

The rules are structured in three parts: Core Game Rules (Articles 1-14), Online Governance (Article 15), and Engine Compliance Standards (Article 16).

PART I: CORE GAME RULES

1. The Game and Players

1. Draughts-64 (Drafti) is a strategic board game between two players.

2. The participants are defined as players. In official competition, players must be registered with the TZD Federation or an affiliated organization.

3. One player controls white (light) pieces; the other controls black (dark) pieces.

2. The Material

2.1. The Board

4. Draughts-64 is played on a square board divided into 64 equal squares, alternately light and dark.

5. The game is played only on the dark squares. Thus 32 squares are active.

6. The board must be positioned so the long diagonal starts at the left-hand side of each player. The first square at the left of each player must be a dark square.

7. Files are labeled a–h (left to right from White's perspective). Ranks are numbered 1–8 (bottom to top from White's perspective).

Starting Position Diagram

	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
8		b		b		b		b
7	b		b		b		b	
6		b		b		b		b
5								
4								
3	w		w		w		w	
2		w		w		w		w
1	w		w		w		w	

w = White man b = Black man

2.2. The Pieces

8. Each player begins with 12 pieces (men / askari).

9. Starting position: White's 12 men occupy the dark squares of ranks 1, 2, and 3. Black's 12 men occupy the dark squares of ranks 6, 7, and 8. Ranks 4 and 5 are empty.

10. In algebraic notation, the starting position is: White: a1, c1, e1, g1, b2, d2, f2, h2, a3, c3, e3, g3. Black: b6, d6, f6, h6, a7, c7, e7, g7, b8, d8, f8, h8.

3. Movement of Pieces

11. A piece may be either a man (askari) or a king (mfalme).

12. Men and kings have different movement and capturing abilities. The movement of one piece is called a move.

13. The player with White pieces moves first in the opening game of a match. Thereafter, players alternate moves. See Article 12.3 for subsequent-game starting player conventions.

14. Each move must be executed with one hand only.

3.1. Man Movement (Askari)

15. A man moves diagonally forward one square to an adjacent empty dark square.

> **CRITICAL — Men can NEVER move backward**
>
> Not for regular moves. Not for captures. Not during a multi-jump sequence. Not under any circumstance. White men move toward rank 8. Black men move toward rank 1. Any backward movement by a man is an illegal move and must be rejected.

3.2. King Movement (Mfalme)

16. A king is a man that has been promoted by reaching the opponent's back rank.

17. Upon promotion, the man is crowned with another piece of the same color to indicate king status. Either player may crown it; if the opponent does not, the player must crown their own piece as part of the move. Playing with an uncrowned king constitutes an irregular move.

18. A king moves diagonally forward or backward any number of empty squares along the diagonal it occupies (flying king / mfalme anaruka).

3.3. Completion of Move

19. A move is complete when the player releases the piece after placing it on its destination square.

20. Touch-move rule (sheria ya kugusa): If a player whose turn it is touches a movable piece, that piece must be moved if a legal move exists.

21. Before release, a piece may be placed on any legal destination square.

22. A player wishing to adjust pieces without moving them must first clearly announce 'I adjust' or 'j'adoube.'

4. Capturing

4.1. Capture Direction Rules

23. Men (askari): Can ONLY capture in forward diagonal directions. White men capture toward rank 8; Black men capture toward rank 1. This applies in single captures, multi-jump sequences, and all other circumstances without exception.

24. Kings (wafalme): May capture both forward and backward along any diagonal.

25. A capture counts as one complete move. Players cannot capture their own pieces.

4.2. Man Capture Procedure

26. When a man encounters an opponent's piece on an adjacent forward diagonal square, with a free square immediately beyond, the man must jump over the opponent's piece and land on the free square. The opponent's piece is captured and removed.

> **Backward captures by men are illegal**
> If during a capture sequence a backward capture opportunity appears, the man cannot take it. Men must only capture in forward diagonals. Any capture requiring backward movement is illegal.

4.3. King Capture Procedure

27. When a king encounters an opponent's piece anywhere along its diagonal, with one or more free squares beyond, the king must jump over the piece and land on any free square beyond it (player's choice).

4.4. Capture Execution

28. Captures must be clearly indicated. The capturing piece must be placed down on each intermediate square during multiple captures.

29. All capturing and piece removal must be done with one hand. Using two hands is irregular.

30. Captured pieces remain on the board until the capture sequence is complete, then are removed in the order captured.

4.5. Multiple Captures by Men

31. If after capturing, a man encounters another opponent piece on a forward diagonal with a free square beyond, it must continue capturing. This continues until no more forward captures are possible.

32. Captured pieces are removed after the complete sequence, in capture order.

4.6. Multiple Captures by Kings

33. When a king captures and can capture again (on the same or perpendicular diagonal), it must continue capturing. The king may change direction during the sequence.

34. The king lands on any free square beyond the last captured piece on that diagonal.

4.7. Multiple Capture Restrictions

35. During a multiple capture, jumping over your own pieces is forbidden.

36. Passing over the same empty square multiple times is permitted.

37. Jumping over the same opponent piece more than once is forbidden (Turkish strike rule).

4.8. Capture Completion

38. A capture sequence is complete when the player releases the capturing piece.

39. Piece removal is complete when all captured pieces are removed or the player clearly stops the removal process.

4.9. Capture Choice (Free Choice / Chaguo Huru)

40. Tanzania Draughts-64 uses FREE CHOICE capture: When multiple capture options exist, the player may choose any legal capture, regardless of the quantity or quality of pieces captured.

> *Note: This differs from the Brazilian variant's maximum capture rule. Free choice applies in all TZD competition.*

4.10. Promotion During Capture

41. CORRECTED RULE: If a man reaches the opponent's back rank during a capture sequence, the capture sequence ENDS immediately. The man is promoted to king and stops on the back rank. No further captures are made in that turn, even if forward captures are available.

42. The newly promoted king may capture on the next turn if opportunities exist.

43. If a man reaches the back rank without any capture in that move, it is promoted immediately and may capture as a king on the next move.

5. The Supa Rule (Drafti Safi)

New in v3.0 — Critical gap addressed

The Supa rule is the most distinctive feature of competitive Tanzania Draughts play. It was absent from v2.2 and is now formally codified.

44. A Supa (pronounced 'SUPER'; also called Drafti Safi — Clean Drafti) is achieved when a player wins a game without the opponent ever promoting a man to king during that game.

45. Supa applies only when the winning player captures all of the opponent's pieces or the opponent resigns or runs out of time, AND the opponent has not promoted any man to king at any point during the game.

46. In competition where points are awarded, a Supa victory is valued at twelve (12) standard game points, compared to one (1) point for a standard win. Tournament directors must announce Supa scoring before a tournament begins.

47. In casual and unscored play, a Supa is acknowledged as a mark of skill but carries no mandatory scoring multiplier unless players agree otherwise before the game.

48. A game that ends in a draw cannot produce a Supa, regardless of whether either player promoted a king.

49. The server or arbiter confirms Supa status. A Supa claim is valid only if confirmed by the game record showing no opponent promotion event.

Optional extended Supa: By prior agreement between players or tournament declaration, a Supa may be valued differently (e.g., 6× or 20×). The default Federation value is 12×.

6. Variant Rules (Reference Only)

The Brazilian variant of Draughts-64 differs from Tanzania rules in two key ways:

- Maximum capture required (not used in Tanzania Draughts)
- Promotion mid-capture continues as man (not used in Tanzania Draughts)

These variant rules do NOT apply to official Tanzania Draughts Federation play.

7. Irregularities

50. If incorrect board orientation is discovered during a game, the game is annulled and replayed.

51. Starting position compliance must be verified before starting. Irregularities noted during play may be rectified at the opponent's discretion.

52. If a player accidentally displaces pieces, they must restore the correct position on their own time.

53. When a player commits an irregularity, the opponent may choose to demand rectification or allow the irregular play to stand.

54. Common irregularities include: playing two moves consecutively; moving a piece illegally; touching one piece but moving another; taking back a completed move; moving the opponent's

piece; moving when capture is mandatory; capturing incorrect number of pieces; stopping mid-capture; removing pieces not jumped; using two hands for moves or captures; playing with an uncrowned king.

55. If the opponent makes a move after an irregularity, this constitutes acceptance and rectification can no longer be claimed.

56. Partial rectification is not permitted.

57. The referee may penalize players who commit irregularities.

8. Game Result

A game ends in one of two ways: a win for one player (loss for the other), or a draw.

8.1. Winning the Game

A player wins when the opponent:

- Resigns voluntarily
- Has no legal moves (all pieces captured or blocked)
- Has no pieces remaining on the board
- Runs out of time in a timed game (subject to Article 11.3)
- Refuses to comply with official rules after warning

8.2. Draw by Agreement

58. Players may agree to a draw by mutual consent at any time during the game.

59. Draw offers should be made after completing your own move and before the opponent responds.

9. Draw Conditions

Tanzania Draughts uses simplified draw rules for practical tournament implementation.

9.1. Insufficient Material

60. The game is a draw if neither player has sufficient material to force a win: one king each (K vs K), one king plus one or more men versus one king where the stronger side cannot demonstrate progress within the 30-move window (see 9.3).

> **Correction from v2.2**
>
> Article 8.4 in v2.2 stated K vs K, K+Man vs K, and 2K vs K are 'automatic draws after 5 moves.' This was incorrect. These positions are NOT automatic draws. They are subject to the 30-move rule (Article 9.3). The 5-move automatic draw rule had no basis in TZD practice and has been removed.

9.2. Threefold Repetition

61. If the same position occurs three times with the same player to move, that player may claim a draw.

62. In online play, the server automatically detects threefold repetition and offers a draw claim to the player whose turn it is. The player must accept to end the game; the game does not automatically end. This reconciles the claim-based OTB rule with server detection capability.

9.3. 30-Move Rule

63. If 30 consecutive full moves occur — meaning 60 half-moves total, 30 by each player — with only kings on the board and no captures made by either side, either player may claim a draw. The arbiter or server may enforce this automatically.

> **Clarification added in v3.0**
>
> '30 moves' means 30 full moves (one white half-move plus one black half-move = one full move), totalling 60 half-moves. This replaces the ambiguous 'by both players' language in v2.2.

9.4. Three Kings vs One King Rule

64. If a player has three or more kings against one enemy king, and the stronger side controls the long diagonal, the stronger side has 12 moves (counting only the stronger side's moves) from the moment the imbalance is established to win. If no win is achieved in 12 moves by the stronger side, the game is a draw.

> **Conflict resolved from v2.2**
>
> Article 8.5 (v2.2) said 12 moves. Article 13.5 (v2.2) said 15 moves. The correct TZD Federation standard is 12 moves by the stronger side. Article 16 (engine compliance) now matches. The 15-move figure has been removed everywhere.

9.5. Optional House Rules

65. The following optional rules may be applied by agreement of both players or by tournament declaration before play begins:

- Extended count: In the 3-kings-vs-1-king scenario, players may agree to a different move limit (commonly 16 or 20 moves) before a draw is called.
- Piece exchange: After each game, players swap colors (pieces). This is common practice in casual TZ play.
- Loser starts: The player who lost the previous game moves first in the next game, irrespective of color assignment.

None of these optional rules apply to Federation-sanctioned tournament play unless explicitly declared by the tournament director.

10. Algebraic Notation

66. Draughts-64 uses standard algebraic notation. Files are labeled a–h; ranks are numbered 1–8.

67. Each dark square is identified by its file letter and rank number (e.g., a1, c3, h8).

68. Move notation: Simple move: starting square, hyphen, destination square (e.g., a3-b4). Capture: starting square, 'x', landing square (e.g., a3xc5). Multiple capture: show each intermediate square (e.g., d2xf4xh6xf8).

> **Notation unified in v3.0**
> v2.2 used colon (:) for captures in some places and 'x' in others. PDN standard (Portable Draughts Notation) uses 'x' for captures. All TZD notation now uses 'x' consistently.

69. Annotation symbols: ! = good move, !! = excellent move, ? = weak move, ?? = blunder, !? = interesting move, ?! = dubious move, + = winning position, = = drawn position.

70. Move recording obligation: Players must record moves in Classical time control. Recording is recommended but not mandatory in Rapid. Recording is not required in Blitz. Incomplete notation does not invalidate a game but may affect dispute resolution.

11. Time Control

71. Games may be played with time controls. When time controls are used, a chess clock or digital timer is required.

72. Time control formats:

- Classical: 60 or more minutes per player. Move recording required.
- Rapid: 10–30 minutes per player, or 10–15 minutes plus Fischer increment. Recording recommended.
- Blitz: 3–5 minutes per player, or 3–5 minutes plus Fischer increment. Recording not required.
- Bullet: Under 3 minutes per player. Online platforms only.

73. When a player's time expires, that player loses unless the opponent has insufficient material to force a win as defined in Article 9.1, in which case the game is drawn.

12. Competition Regulations

74. All TZD Federation-sanctioned tournaments must follow these official rules.

75. Tournament directors have authority to make rulings on disputes and irregularities.

76. Players must conduct themselves professionally. Unsporting behavior may result in warnings, penalties, or disqualification.

77. Electronic devices (phones, tablets, etc.) are prohibited during play unless specifically authorized by the tournament director.

78. Starting player in subsequent games: After the opening game, the loser of the previous game starts the next game as the default. If the optional 'piece exchange' rule is in effect, colors swap. Tournament directors may specify an alternative arrangement.

13. Rating System

New in v3.0 — Critical gap addressed
No rating standard existed in v2.2. This article establishes the official TZD Elo-based rating system.

79. The TZD Federation uses the Elo rating system for all rated games.

80. Initial rating: All new registered players receive a provisional rating of 1200. Players remain provisional for their first 30 rated games.

81. K-factor: Provisional players (first 30 games): K = 40. Established players rated below 2000: K = 20. Players rated 2000 and above: K = 10.

82. Elo formula: The expected score for Player A against Player B is $E_A = 1 / (1 + 10^{((R_B - R_A)/400)})$. After a game, the new rating is $R_{A_new} = R_A + K \times (S_A - E_A)$, where $S_A = 1$ for a win, 0.5 for a draw, 0 for a loss.

83. Supa scoring: A Supa win counts as one win (S = 1.0) for rating purposes. The 12× multiplier applies to tournament points only, not to Elo calculation.

84. Minimum rating: No player's rating may fall below 800, regardless of results.

85. Rating updates: Ratings are updated after each rated game for online play, and after each tournament round for OTB events.

86. Unrated games: Friendly games, practice games, and games on unapproved platforms do not affect ratings.

14. Tournament Formats

New in v3.0 — Critical gap addressed
v2.2 had no tournament format specifications. This article establishes the standard formats for TZD Federation events.

87. TZD Federation tournaments use the following formats:

- Swiss system: Players are paired by similar scores each round. The number of rounds is typically ceil(log2(n)) + 1 where n is the number of players. No player plays the same opponent twice.
- Round-robin: Each player plays every other player once (single round-robin) or twice (double round-robin, with color alternation). Used for elite and championship events.
- Knockout (elimination): Single or double elimination. Used for rapid and blitz events.

88. Tiebreak criteria (in order of priority for Swiss and round-robin): 1. Direct encounter result; 2. Supa count (more Supa wins ranks higher); 3. Buchholz score; 4. Number of wins; 5. Drawing of lots.

89. Scoring: Win = 1 point. Draw = 0.5 points. Loss = 0 points. Supa win = 12 tournament points (if Supa scoring is in effect; declared before the tournament begins).

90. A minimum of 6 players is required for a Federation-sanctioned Swiss tournament. Round-robin events require a minimum of 4 players.

PART II: ONLINE GOVERNANCE

15. Online Play Standards

These provisions govern digital and online play on TZD Federation-approved platforms.

15.1. Server Authority

91. The game server is the authoritative referee for all online play. Server decisions on move legality are final.

92. The server validates all moves before execution. Illegal moves are automatically rejected.

93. Game state is maintained by the server. Client displays are for visualization only.

15.2. Automatic Rule Enforcement

The server automatically enforces:

- Legal move validation (piece movement rules including forward-only men)
- Mandatory captures — if a capture is available, non-capturing moves are rejected
- Automatic promotion on reaching the back rank
- Promotion-ends-capture: when a man reaches the back rank during a capture sequence, the sequence stops
- Turn order enforcement
- Time control enforcement
- Threefold repetition detection — server offers the draw claim to the player whose turn it is; the player must accept
- 30-move rule detection and enforcement (60 half-moves by both sides, kings only, no captures)
- Three-kings-vs-one: server tracks and enforces the 12-move limit
- Supa detection: server records whether a player promoted during the game and flags Supa outcomes automatically

15.3. Time Management

94. Server clock is authoritative. Client clocks are advisory only.

95. Time expires when server clock reaches zero. Automatic loss results (or draw if opponent cannot win per Article 9.1).

96. Fischer increment (if used) is added by server after each move completion.

15.4. Disconnection Policy

97. If a player disconnects, their clock continues running.

98. Grace period: Players have 90 seconds to reconnect. This is the fixed Federation standard for approved platforms; it is not configurable for rated games.

99. If time expires during disconnection, the player loses.

100. Upon reconnection, the game continues from the current server-held position.

101. Repeated disconnections (three or more in a single game) may be reported as unsporting conduct and reviewed by the Federation.

> **Clarification from v2.2**
> v2.2 said grace period was 'configurable, typically 60–120 seconds.' For rated games on approved platforms the period is now fixed at 90 seconds. Unrated and casual modes may vary.

15.5. Fair Play and Anti-Cheating

102. Use of engines, outside assistance, or multiple accounts during online play is strictly prohibited.

103. Detection methods: The TZD Federation may deploy anti-cheating detection including move pattern analysis, timing analysis, and statistical comparison with engine play.

104. Investigation procedure: When a violation is suspected, the following process applies: (a) The platform flags the game and notifies the Federation. (b) The player is notified within 48 hours that their account is under review. (c) The player has 7 days to submit a written response. (d) The Federation rules within 14 days of receiving the response. (e) The player may appeal within 7 days of the ruling to the Appeals Committee.

105. Sanctions on confirmed violation: Game forfeiture; account suspension (minimum 30 days for first offence); rating adjustment; tournament disqualification. Repeat offences may result in permanent ban.

15.6. Appeals and Disputes

106. Technical errors: If a player believes a server error occurred, they must report it within 24 hours via the platform's dispute mechanism. Disputes raised after 24 hours will not be reviewed.

107. Server logs are authoritative evidence. Appeals are reviewed by TZD Federation officials.

108. Fair play violations: Suspected cheating should be reported via rules@tzdrafti.or.tz. The TZD Federation investigates and rules per the procedure in Article 15.5.

15.7. Platform Requirements

TZD Federation-approved platforms must:

- Implement all TZD rules correctly, including the Supa rule, free-choice capture, forward-only men, promotion-ends-capture, and the 12-move three-kings rule
- Maintain secure game logs for at least 90 days
- Use algebraic notation with 'x' for captures (PDN standard)
- Support standard time controls: Classical, Rapid, Blitz, Bullet
- Provide move validation feedback to players
- Allow game download in PDN format (Portable Draughts Notation) with GameType 21 header
- Display Supa outcome on game completion screen

PART III: ENGINE COMPLIANCE STANDARDS

16. Engine Implementation Requirements

These technical specifications ensure draughts engines correctly implement TZD rules.

16.1. Board Representation

109. Engines must support the 8×8 board with algebraic notation (a1–h8).

110. Active dark squares (32 total): a1, c1, e1, g1, b2, d2, f2, h2, a3, c3, e3, g3, b4, d4, f4, h4, a5, c5, e5, g5, b6, d6, f6, h6, a7, c7, e7, g7, b8, d8, f8, h8.

111. Piece representation: White man = 'w', White king = 'W', Black man = 'b', Black king = 'B'.

16.2. Move Generation Rules

CRITICAL — Backward movement by men must be rejected

Any move or capture that would require a man to move toward its own starting ranks is illegal. White men: move and capture ONLY toward rank 8. Black men: move and capture ONLY toward rank 1. This must be enforced in all circumstances including multi-jump sequences.

112. King moves: bidirectional (forward and backward) along diagonals. Flying kings may move and capture any distance along clear diagonals.

16.3. Capture Logic

113. Mandatory capture: If any capture is available, non-capturing moves are illegal.

114. Free choice: When multiple capture options exist, the engine must generate all legal captures and allow the player (or its own evaluation) to choose freely. No maximum-capture filtering is applied.

115. Multi-capture rules: Continue capturing until no further captures are possible; cannot jump the same piece twice (Turkish strike); may pass over the same empty square multiple times; cannot jump own pieces.

116. Promotion during capture: The capture sequence ends immediately when a man reaches the back rank. The man is promoted to king. The king may capture on the next turn only.

117. Supa tracking: Engines must track whether each player has promoted any man during the game. This state must be accessible at game end for Supa determination.

16.4. Position Evaluation

Engines should evaluate positions based on:

- Material: Man = 1.0 unit, King = 2.5–3.0 units (engine developers may refine based on testing)
- Position: Center control, piece mobility, king placement, back rank control
- Tactical factors: Forcing sequences, tempo advantages, piece coordination
- Endgame: Known theoretical outcomes and tablebase results

16.5. Draw Detection

Engines must detect and enforce:

- Threefold repetition (same position, same player to move, three times)
- 30-move rule: 60 consecutive half-moves with only kings on the board and no captures
- Insufficient material as defined in Article 9.1
- Three-kings rule: 12 moves by the stronger side (NOT 15 — this was corrected from v2.2)

Conflict resolved from v2.2

v2.2 Article 13.5 specified '15-move rule (3+ kings vs 1 king).' This contradicted Article 8.5 which said 12 moves. The correct value is 12 moves by the stronger side. All engine implementations must use 12.

16.6. Protocol Support

TZD-compliant engines should support:

- Standard input/output communication (HUB protocol recommended; DXP also acceptable)
- Position setup via FEN notation as defined in Appendix B
- Move output in algebraic notation with 'x' for captures (e.g., a3-b4, c3xe5xg7)
- Time control management
- Search depth or time limits
- Supa state reporting: on game end, report whether opponent promoted any piece

16.7. Testing and Certification

118. Engines seeking TZD Federation certification must pass a test suite covering: move legality (100+ positions); mandatory capture enforcement; promotion rules; multi-capture including direction restrictions for men; draw condition detection; Supa state tracking.

119. Test suites and certification requests: Submit to rules@tzdrafti.or.tz with subject line 'Engine Certification Request'. Include engine name, version, developer contact, and platform(s) targeted.

120. Certification review: The Federation will respond within 30 days of receiving a complete submission. Certification is valid for 2 years or until a major rule change.

121. Certification fee: Currently waived for open-source engines. Commercial engines: contact the Federation for current fee schedule.

16.8. Critical Implementation Errors to Avoid

The following errors are the most common incorrect implementations:

1. Allowing men to move backward — the most critical error. Men can NEVER move backward for any reason.
2. Allowing men to capture backward — men can only capture forward.
3. Requiring maximum capture — this is the Brazilian variant rule, not used in TZD.
4. Allowing promotion mid-capture to continue as king — the sequence must stop at the back rank.
5. Using 15 moves for the three-kings rule — the correct value is 12.

6. Not tracking Supa state — the engine must record whether each player promoted during the game.
7. Using colon notation for captures — TZD uses 'x' (PDN standard).

Appendix A. Rule Clarifications Summary

Key differences from common variants:

Rule Aspect	Tanzania Draughts-64	Brazilian Variant
Man capture direction	Forward only (CRITICAL)	Forward only
Capture choice	Free choice (any legal capture)	Maximum capture required
Promotion during capture	Stops immediately on back rank	Continues as man
King movement	Flying king (any distance)	Flying king (any distance)
Three-kings rule	12 moves by stronger side	FMJD complex rules
Draw rules	Simplified TZD rules	Complex FMJD rules
Supa rule	Yes — 12× tournament points	Not applicable

Appendix B. PDN and FEN Technical Specification

New in v3.0 — Critical gap addressed

v2.2 referenced 'PGN-equivalent' format without defining it. TZD uses PDN (Portable Draughts Notation), not PGN. This appendix defines the exact format.

B.1. Portable Draughts Notation (PDN)

All TZD games must be stored and exchanged in PDN format. PDN is the standard for draughts, analogous to PGN for chess.

Required PDN header tags:

Tag	Value / Example	Required
[Event]	"TZD Ranked" | "TZD Friendly" | "TZD Tournament"	Yes
[Site]	Platform URL e.g. tzdrafti.co.tz	Yes
[Date]	YYYY.MM.DD e.g. 2026.04.01	Yes
[Round]	Round number or "-" for casual	Yes
[White]	Username of White player	Yes
[Black]	Username of Black player	Yes
[Result]	"1-0" | "0-1" | "1/2-1/2"	Yes
[GameType]	"21" — Standard code for 8x8 Russian-style	Yes
[Variant]	"Tanzanian"	Yes

Tag	Value / Example	Required
[TimeControl]	"600+5" (10 min + 5 sec increment)	Recommended
[Termination]	"Resigned" | "Timeout" | "Checkmate" | "Draw"	Recommended
[Supa]	"1" if Supa achieved, "0" otherwise	Recommended
[WhiteElo]	Numeric Elo rating	Optional
[BlackElo]	Numeric Elo rating	Optional

B.2. FEN Position Notation

Positions are encoded in standard draughts FEN format:

Format: <color>:<white-pieces>:<black-pieces>

- Color: W = White to move, B = Black to move
- Pieces: K prefix for kings, bare number for men (e.g., K15 = king on e3, 22 = man on f4)
- Starting position FEN:
  W:W21,22,23,24,25,26,27,28,29,30,31,32:B1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9,10,11,12

Square numbering (1–32, dark squares only, left to right, bottom to top from White's view):

Rank	Squares (left to right, dark squares)
Rank 1 (White's base)	1=a1 2=c1 3=e1 4=g1
Rank 2	5=b2 6=d2 7=f2 8=h2
Rank 3	9=a3 10=c3 11=e3 12=g3
Rank 4	13=b4 14=d4 15=f4 16=h4
Rank 5	17=a5 18=c5 19=e5 20=g5
Rank 6	21=b6 22=d6 23=f6 24=h6
Rank 7	25=a7 26=c7 27=e7 28=g7
Rank 8 (Black's base)	29=b8 30=d8 31=f8 32=h8

Appendix C. Glossary (English / Swahili)

New in v3.0 — Critical gap addressed

v2.2 had no glossary or Swahili terminology. Tanzania Draughts has a rich Swahili vocabulary used in competitive play.

English Term	Swahili	Definition
Draughts / Checkers	Drafti	The game itself
Man / Piece	Askari	An uncrowned game piece
King	Mfalme	A promoted piece; moves any distance diagonally
Flying king	Mfalme anaruka	A king that moves any number of squares
Capture	Kukamata / Kupiga	Jumping over and removing an opponent's piece
Mandatory capture	Lazima kukamata	Obligation to capture when a capture is available
Promotion	Kutawazwa	A man reaching the opponent's back rank and becoming a king
Supa / Drafti Safi	Supa / Drafti Safi	Winning without the opponent ever promoting; worth 12× points
Draw	Sare	A game that ends without a winner
Touch-move rule	Sheria ya kugusa	Once you touch a piece, you must move it
Forward (White)	Mbele (Nyeupe)	Toward rank 8
Forward (Black)	Mbele (Nyeusi)	Toward rank 1
Free choice capture	Chaguo huru	The player may choose any legal capture
Long diagonal	Diagonal ndefu	The diagonal connecting corner squares a1–h8 or h1–a8
Back rank	Safu ya nyuma	The opponent's starting rank (rank 8 for White, rank 1 for Black)

Appendix D. Version History

Version 3.0 (Current) — Comprehensive Edition — Effective 1 April 2026

All 23 gaps identified in the v2.2 gap analysis have been addressed:

8. CRITICAL: Added Article 5 — Supa Rule (Drafti Safi) — formally defines Supa, 12× scoring, and conditions
9. CRITICAL: Resolved 3-kings-vs-1-king conflict — standardised at 12 moves throughout (Articles 9.4 and 16.5)
10. CRITICAL: Corrected Article 9.1 draw conditions — removed incorrect 'automatic draw after 5 moves' for K vs K positions; replaced with 30-move rule reference
11. CRITICAL: Added Appendix B — PDN and FEN Technical Specification; GameType 21; defined FEN format; replaced incorrect 'PGN-equivalent' reference
12. CRITICAL: Added FEN square numbering table (1–32) for engine integration

13. HIGH: Added Article 13 — Rating System (Elo, K-factors, Supa scoring, provisional ratings)
14. HIGH: Added Article 14 — Tournament Formats (Swiss, round-robin, knockout, tiebreaks, Supa scoring)
15. HIGH: Resolved Article 3 first-move conflict — White moves first in opening game; subsequent games follow loser-starts convention
16. HIGH: Added move recording obligation details to Article 10
17. HIGH: Fixed disconnection grace period — now fixed at 90 seconds for rated play (Article 15.4)
18. HIGH: Added full anti-cheating investigation procedure with timeline (Article 15.5)
19. HIGH: Added engine certification contact, process, timeline, and fee policy (Article 16.7)
20. HIGH: Resolved threefold repetition OTB-vs-online conflict — server detects, player claims (Article 9.2 + 15.2)
21. MEDIUM: Added starting position board diagram with square labels (Article 2)
22. MEDIUM: Added optional house rules section (piece exchange, loser starts) — Article 9.5
23. MEDIUM: Defined 'insufficient material' explicitly (Article 9.1)
24. MEDIUM: Clarified 30-move counting — 30 full moves = 60 half-moves total (Article 9.3)
25. MEDIUM: Added Appendix C — Glossary in English and Swahili
26. MEDIUM: Unified clause numbering sequentially across entire document
27. LOW: Added Table of Contents
28. LOW: Added TZD Federation contact information and website
29. LOW: Added effective date (1 April 2026)
30. LOW: Unified capture notation — 'x' throughout, consistent with PDN standard

Version 2.2 — Publication Ready Edition (Superseded)

Established consistent TZD terminology; clarified three-kings article language; enhanced engine evaluation guidance; professional formatting.

Version 2.1 — Critical Clarification (Superseded)

Removed incorrect language suggesting men can move backward. Strengthened man-movement rules throughout.

Version 2.0 — Federation Edition (Superseded)

Added online governance (Article 12), engine compliance (Article 13), simplified draw rules, corrected promotion-during-capture rule.

Version 1.0 — Initial Release (Superseded)

Based on FMJD Draughts-64 rules with Tanzania adaptations.

Appendix E. Acknowledgments

These rules were developed by the Tanzania Draughts Federation Rules Committee with reference to FMJD international standards and input from:

- International Draughts Federation (FMJD) official rulebooks
- Russian Draughts Federation materials
- Tanzania national players and tournament directors
- Engine developers and online platform operators
- TzDraft platform team — technical standards contributions (Articles 15–16 and Appendix B)